

SASE for OT security in energy utilities, addressing NIS2 compliance and legacy ICS vulnerabilities.

Energy × OT and industrial control system security × SASE and SSE · OS094 v1 · refreshed 2026-08-18

ATTRACTIVENESS	RIGHT TO WIN	COMPETITION	SERVICEABLE MARKET	HORIZON	PORTFOLIO
68 is the world moving	72 can we play, can we win	MEDIUM 0 named in the evidence	€263m observed evidence · per year	NOW budgeted procurement within 1...	L0 13 signals

Attractiveness and right to win are scored and displayed separately and are never combined (SC-12). Competition is a fourth quantity, not a discount on either.

Evidence gap (SC-13). Orange has 3.0 published reference(s) in Energy, below the threshold of 5. A customer conversation here has no proof point behind it yet.

The opportunity

This opportunity targets energy utilities and critical infrastructure operators that must secure legacy industrial control systems (ICS) while meeting NIS2-style regulatory pressure. Orange Business can assemble a SASE-based architecture that converges secure access to OT environments with managed cybersecurity services, addressing both compliance and operational resilience. The timing is now because a French energy group is already procuring a SASE solution, signaling active market demand.

Market opportunity

Method	Total (TAM)	Serviceable (SAM)	Obtainable (SOM)	Confidence
Bottom-up: enterprises x adoption x contract value	€319m €71.3m – €4.0bn	€263m €58.7m – €3.3bn	€15.8m €3.5m – €200m	observed
Observed: tendered contract value, annualised	€172m €172m – €460m	€172m €172m – €460m	€10.3m €10.3m – €27.6m	observed

All figures are annual, in EUR. Ranges compound the uncertainty of each factor below; the base case is the middle column of each.

Bottom-up: enterprises x adoption x contract value

Factor	Value	Basis	Source	As of
Enterprises in Energy (EU27_2020)	5,796 enterprises	observed	Eurostat · sbs_sc_ovw	2024
Enterprises adopting SASE and SSE	79.4 % of enterprises (10+ employees)	observed	Eurostat · isoc_cisce_ran2 · E_SECMVPN	2024
Annual value of one engagement	€299k per enterprise per year	observed	TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) · ted	2026-05-19..2026-08-07
Size-weighted buyer base	1,341 enterprise-equivalents at large-enterprise engagement value	assumption	config/sizing.yaml · size_class_value_weights	size-2026-08-a
Assumed obtainable share of the serviceable market	6.0 % of SAM	assumption	config/sizing.yaml · obtainable_share	size-2026-08-a

Read this before quoting the number. Contract values are observed from EU public procurement (TED). For private-sector verticals they are used as a proxy for comparable enterprise deal size: the buying entity differs, the scope of work is comparable. Engagement value is scaled by enterprise size class (10-19: x0.04, 20-49: x0.09, 50-249: x0.35, GE250: x1.0), because the observed contract value comes from large-organisation tenders.

Observed: tendered contract value, annualised

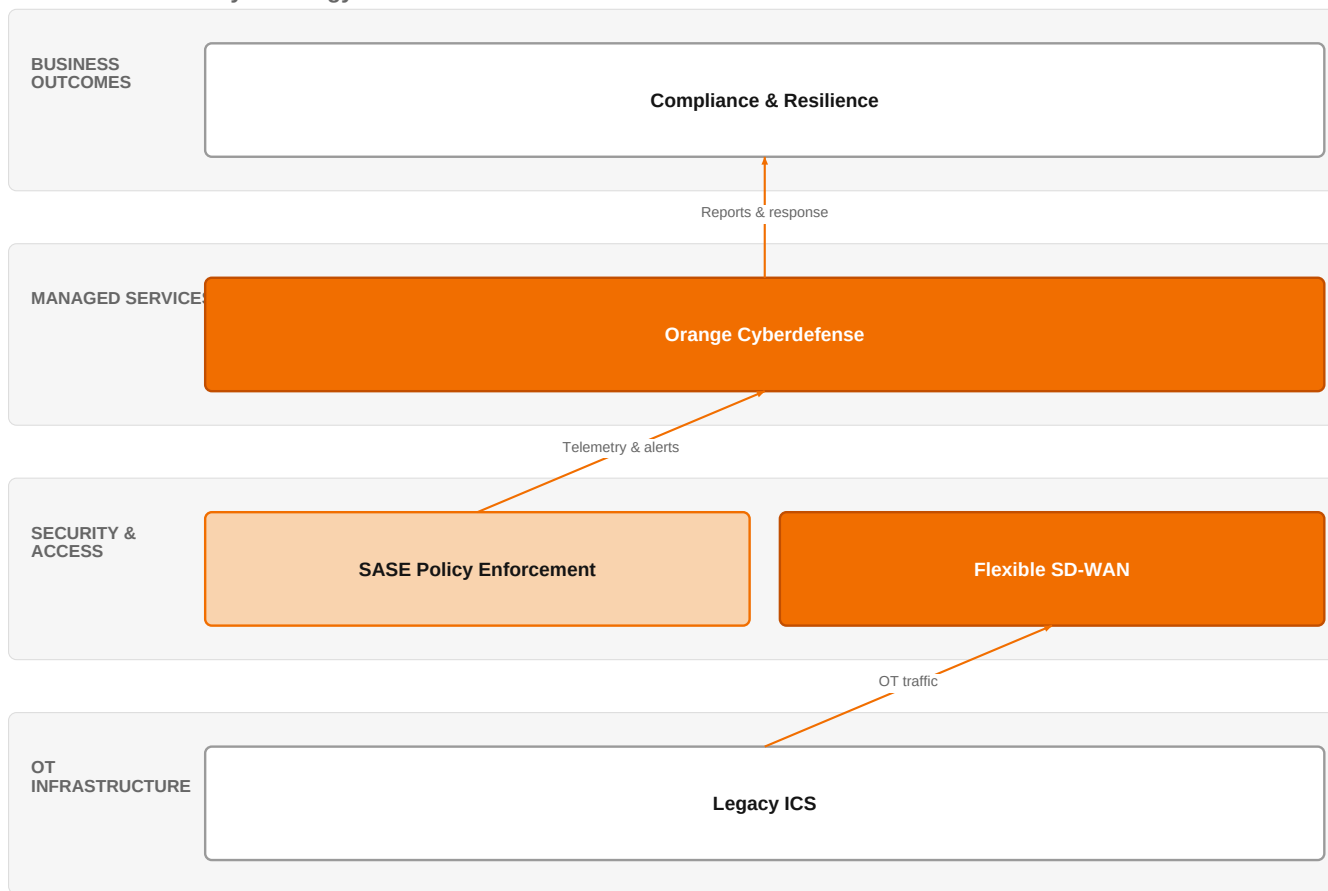
Factor	Value	Basis	Source	As of
Tendered contract value in matching CPV categories	€172m per year	observed	TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) · ted	2026-05-19..2026-08-07
Assumed obtainable share of the serviceable market	6.0 % of SAM	assumption	config/sizing.yaml · obtainable_share	size-2026-08-a

Read this before quoting the number. Observed over 85 days of TED coverage and scaled to a year (x4.3); a short collection window makes that scaling rough. 21 matching notices, matched on vertical via the CPV crosswalk — §4.5.2's warning applies: a crosswalk error lands directly in this number. Public procurement only. Private-sector demand for the same capability is not visible here at all, so this is a floor rather than a

market size.

The solution, in one picture

SASE for OT Security in Energy Utilities



■ Orange asset ■ Partner ■ Customer-owned ■ Third party / to be sourced

This picture shows how Orange integrates its SD-WAN and managed security services with partner SASE enforcement to protect legacy ICS while delivering compliance and resilience.

Boxes marked as Orange assets are validated against the linked business graph; a box the model claimed for Orange without a matching asset is shown as third party.

What has changed

Cyberattacks increasingly target industrial control systems that manage critical infrastructure such as energy, water, and manufacturing, yet many incidents go unreported, delaying response and recovery. Regulatory bodies are pushing for binding directives, as seen in calls for CISA to issue mandatory OT cybersecurity rules after attacks disrupted water utilities. Academic research highlights the growing complexity of ICS security, with risk assessment needing to integrate both safety and security perspectives, and new approaches like edge AI and federated learning emerging for anomaly detection. A French energy group is already procuring a SASE solution for cybersecurity, indicating concrete market movement.

Sources: SIG-0CB746316F44 International Journal 2026-05-21; SIG-FCFE20A18D9A Industrial Cyber 2026-08-03; SIG-FA6096A63EB Elsevier BV 2026-01-01; SIG-F48074B55B20 openalex.org 2025-10-16; SIG-F633044AF87A openalex.org 2026-01-29; SIG-DCE7F8BBD462 boamp.fr 2026-07-12

Who buys, and why now

The chief information security officer (CISO) or head of OT security signs the contract, while the operational technology (OT) manager feels the daily pain of securing legacy ICS that were never designed for network connectivity. The trigger is often a regulatory audit, a near-miss cyber incident, or a mandate from the board to align with NIS2-style requirements. They need to demonstrate compliance without disrupting production, and they struggle with the complexity of patching aging systems and the lack of visibility into OT network traffic.

Why it is hot now — every claim bound to a dated source

- A French energy group is acquiring a SASE solution for cybersecurity, indicating demand for secure access in critical infrastructure. [SIG-DCE7F8BBD462]

What Orange would deliver, and why it can win

What Orange would deliver

Orange would start with a discovery phase using its Cybersecurity experts to assess the current OT environment and compliance gaps. Then, it would design a SASE architecture leveraging Flexible SD-WAN to securely connect remote sites and OT segments, with policy enforcement via partner technologies like Palo Alto Networks or Zscaler. Orange Cyberdefense managed services would provide 24/7 monitoring and incident response, all underpinned by ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications to meet sovereignty requirements. The engagement would be phased: assess, design, deploy, and manage.

Why Orange can win

Orange can win because it combines its own cybersecurity expertise and managed services with a portfolio of certified solutions (ISO 27001, SecNumCloud) and strong partner technologies. The ability to offer a fully managed, sovereign SASE solution for OT is a differentiator, especially for European energy utilities concerned about data residency. However, the assets are thin on specific OT-specific capabilities, so Orange must lean on its partners and its managed service wrapper to compete effectively.

Named assets behind this — each individually inspectable (LK-08)

Asset	Type	Link	Why it is linked	Curator
Orange Cyberdefense managed services	offer	L0	offer addresses the use case AND provides the technology	unconfirmed
Flexible SD-WAN	offer	L1	offer provides the technology in a matching domain	unconfirmed
Palo Alto Networks	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
Cisco	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
Fortinet	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
Zscaler	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
ISO 27001	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
SecNumCloud	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
Cybersecurity experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
IoT experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Digital experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Defense and security experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Orange Group researchers	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed

Competitive landscape

MEDIUM competitive intensity (score 7.0; 0 of 8 listed players appear in this topic's own evidence)

A real field, including at least one player the customer will already know. Expect to be compared.

Competitors include telecom operators like BT, Lumen, and Verizon, which offer SASE and SSE but may lack deep OT expertise. Security specialists like Fortinet, Palo Alto Networks, and Zscaler have strong SASE products but are not managed service providers. Cisco brings network equipment and SASE, while Nomios is a regional integrator. The customer will compare Orange against these players on the basis of integration depth, managed service capability, and sovereignty. Orange's advantage is its ability to combine its own assets with partner technologies and its certifications.

Sources: SIG-DCE7F8BBD462 boamp.fr 2026-07-12

Competitor	Category	Position here	Basis	Evidence
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BT Business	Telecom operator peer	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Connectivity Solutions, Cybersecurity	structural	—
Lumen Technologies	Telecom operator peer	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Connectivity Solutions, Cybersecurity	structural	—
Verizon Business	Telecom operator peer	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Connectivity Solutions, Cybersecurity	structural	—
Fortinet	Security specialist	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Connectivity Solutions, Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Palo Alto Networks	Security specialist	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Zscaler	Security specialist	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Cisco	Network equipment vendor	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Connectivity Solutions, Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Nomios	Regional integrator or reseller	sells SASE and SSE; competes in Connectivity Solutions, Cybersecurity	structural	—

evidenced means this topic's own sources name the competitor — the signal ids are in the last column and are dated and clickable in the radar. **structural** means the curated register says they sell this technology into this vertical, which is true but is not proof they are in this deal. Register version competitors-2026-08-a.

Qualifying questions for the first meeting

- 1 How are you currently securing remote access to your OT networks, and what are the biggest pain points?
- 2 Have you been audited for NIS2 or similar regulations, and what gaps were identified?
- 3 What is your current visibility into OT network traffic, and how do you detect anomalies?
- 4 Are you considering a managed service model for cybersecurity, or do you prefer to keep it in-house?
- 5 What are your data sovereignty requirements for security monitoring and policy enforcement?

Objections you will meet

They will say	You can answer
We already have a SASE solution from a security vendor.	That's true, and many security vendors offer strong SASE. But our value is in the managed service wrapper and the integration with OT-specific needs, backed by our certifications and 24/7 monitoring.
Our OT environment is too sensitive to change.	We understand the sensitivity. That's why we start with a thorough assessment and design a phased deployment that minimizes disruption, using non-intrusive monitoring and gradual policy rollout.
We're not sure NIS2 applies to us.	Even if you're not directly in scope, the trend is clear: regulators are pushing for binding OT security. Proactively addressing it now can save you from costly remediation later.

Risks and unknowns

The main risk is that energy utilities may prefer to work directly with security specialists like Fortinet or Palo Alto Networks, bypassing a telecom operator. Another risk is that OT environments are highly sensitive, and any disruption during deployment could cause operational downtime. It is not yet known how receptive utilities are to a managed SASE model versus an on-premises solution, and whether NIS2 enforcement will be strict enough to drive urgency.

Next action, by role (FR-17)

Role	Do this next
Presales / Proposal	Prepare a bid brief for a French energy group's SASE procurement, detailing how Orange's Flexible SD-WAN and Orange Cyberdefense managed services, combined with partnerships with Palo Alto Networks, Cisco, Fortinet, and Zscaler, meet NIS2 compliance and secure legacy ICS.
Sales	In a conversation with a French energy group's CISO, say: 'Given your SASE procurement for cybersecurity, we can help you address NIS2 compliance and legacy ICS vulnerabilities with our Flexible SD-WAN and Orange Cyberdefense managed services, backed by ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications.'
Strategist / Innovator	Commission a deep-dive brief on how Orange's Flexible SD-WAN and Orange Cyberdefense managed services can be positioned for OT security in energy utilities, leveraging ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications, and engaging Palo Alto Networks, Cisco, Fortinet, and Zscaler as partners.

Evidence

Every claim in this brief resolves to one of these. Tier 1 is an authoritative primary source; tier 4 is vendor-published material, discounted in scoring (§4.3.7).

Signal	Date	Publisher	T	Title and link
SIG-14F7129DC5EB	2026-08-05	ted.europa.eu	1	Finland – Electricity – Sahkoenergian hankinta
SIG-DCE7F8BBD462	2026-07-12	boamp.fr	1	Acquisition d'une solution SASE (Secure Access Service Edge) pour la cybersécurité du Groupe SO...
SIG-FA23F12226EA	2026-06-24	ted.europa.eu	1	Finland – Electricity – Sahkoenergian hankinta
SIG-C094147C3331	2026-05-27	ted.europa.eu	1	Romania – Feasibility study, advisory service, analysis – Servicii de audit energetic, expertiz...
SIG-0CB746316F44	2026-05-21	International Journal of ...	1	Industrial Control System Cyber Security Frameworks: Assessment using Defense-in-Depth Criteria
SIG-A94A5062DA13	2026-05-19	ted.europa.eu	1	Norway – Alarm-monitoring services – Framework agreement for electronic security.
SIG-F633044AF87A	2026-01-29	openalex.org	1	SecuFL-IoT: an adaptive privacy-preserving federated learning framework for anomaly detection i...
SIG-D8AEDBAD839	2026-01-01	Elsevier BV	1	Robust Energy–Latency Co-Optimization for Power Allocation and Computation Offloading in Edge C...
SIG-FEA6096A63EB	2026-01-01	Elsevier BV	1	A Survey on Key Issues of Risk Assessment methods for Industrial Control System Security and Sa...
SIG-F48074B55B20	2025-10-16	openalex.org	1	Implementation of edge AI for early fault detection in IoT networks: evaluation of performance ...
SIG-FCFE20A18D9A	2026-08-03	Industrial Cyber	2	OTCC urges CISA to issue binding OT cybersecurity directive after cyberattacks disrupt water ut...
SIG-2424954F4021	2026-05-24	arxiv.org	3	ASTRO: Adaptive Spatio-Temporal Reinforcement Optimization for GNN Powered Anomaly Detection in ...
SIG-17DA3B724138	2026-04-27	arxiv.org	3	System-aware contextual digital twin for ICS anomaly diagnosis

How this brief was made

Computed, not written. Attractiveness, right to win, competitive intensity and every figure in the market-opportunity section are computed from stored inputs and can be re-derived (DR-05, NFR-01). No language model produced a number anywhere in this document (§4.4.4).

Written, then checked. The narrative sections and the solution diagram were generated from this topic's evidence and from the named asset and competitor lists. Factual sections must cite signal ids attached to this topic; sections that failed that check, or that contained a generated quantity or an unsupplied organisation, were removed rather than rewritten.

What	Version	When
Scores — weight set	w-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T19:08:26+00:00
Market sizing — assumptions	size-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:14+00:00
Competitor register	competitors-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:17+00:00
Narrative — prompt / model	describe-v1 / deepseek-chat	2026-08-19T04:56:56+00:00
Pipeline	0.1.0	2026-08-18

Generated 2026-08-19 04:58 UTC. Scores computed under a different weight set are not comparable with these (SC-10), and neither are market sizes computed under a different sizing version.